

9. Arrival or departure taxes or fees that are charged for entry or exit from a foreign country may be reimbursed if the traveler incurs the expense directly, rather than including in the transportation ticket cost.

10. A mandatory unaccompanied minor fee that an airline charges for a child traveling alone due to official orders. Reimbursement of the unaccompanied minor fee is not authorized when the child travels alone for member's convenience.

D. Miscellaneous Reimbursable Expenses for Travelers with Medical or Special Needs. A traveler with medical or special needs may receive reimbursement for the following additional transportation-related miscellaneous costs:

1. Specialized services provided by a commercial carrier that are necessary to accommodate the traveler's disability or special need, such as specialized transportation to, from, or at a TDY location.

2. The cost of renting or transporting specialized equipment, such as a wheelchair, needed in transit or at the TDY location.

3. Baggage check-in fee at curbside.

4. Baggage handling tips for a traveler with a disability.

E. Reimbursement When a TMC Is Available but Not Used. When a TMC is available but not used by a traveler, reimbursement for transportation costs is limited to the amount that the Government would have paid if the arrangements had been made directly through a TMC. Transaction fees are not reimbursable, as it should be extremely rare that a TMC is not available.

F. Reimbursement When a TMC Is Not Available. When the AO certifies that a TMC is not available to arrange the required official transportation, the traveler receives reimbursement for the actual authorized or approved transportation costs, including the transaction fee. The total transportation reimbursement must not exceed the policy-constructed fare that meets mission requirements.

G. Reimbursement When a TMC cannot be reached. When the AO certifies that a traveler was unable to make arrangements for official travel through the TMC in a timely manner, the TMC is considered not available. The traveler may receive reimbursement for the actual authorized transportation costs, including the transaction fee. The total transportation reimbursement must not exceed the policy-constructed fare that meets mission requirements. The AO must certify on an individual basis that the authority to self-procure transportation is authorized and TMC unavailability would result in one of the following:

1. An unreasonable burden on mission accomplishment;
2. A compromise of national security interest; or
3. A matter endangering life.

020208. Reimbursement for Government Transportation

A. Reimbursement for Government Plane, Ship, or Bus. An AO may direct a traveler to use Government transportation, such as a plane, ship, or bus over a usually traveled route (see [transportation](#)